Flag 5 of 18: Lateral Movement Account

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Question

The attacker switched identities using a cracked Kerberos service account. What username was used for subsequent lateral movement?

Answer

svc_backup

Evidence

- A `USER_LOGIN` event shows `svc_backup` authenticating from `CYM-DEN-W10-042` (`10.240.32.115`) with the `NtLmSsp` process. The related host listed was `CYM-FS-01.cymbal.corp` . The list view showed 22:06:21.
- Later events show `svc_backup` on `CYM-FS-01` : `cmd.exe` launched by `wsmprovhost.exe` , then `powershell.exe` launched by `cmd.exe` . That is remote command execution through WinRM.
- Earlier, the Denver host had already made WinRM (port 5985) and SMB (port 445) connections to the file server and domain controller.

How it was found

A query-generator prompt asked for logon events from source IP 10.240.32.115 after 20:53 UTC where the user was not marcus.vance. Window: Oct 15 20:53 to Oct 16 03:00 UTC.

UDM equivalent:

```
principal.namespace = "Cymbal"
AND metadata.event_type = "USER_LOGIN"
AND NOT principal.user.userid = "marcus.vance"
```

Lesson

After credential theft, look for a new username coming from the same source host. The change of identity is the signal.

Next pivot

Follow svc_backup on CYM-FS-01 to see what data it collected and staged.

Added: Flag 18 of 18, Staged Archive on the File Server

This flag was missed in the first set of 17 docs. It belongs right after the lateral movement account, because it covers what `svc_backup` did on the file server. It is kept here until a separate doc can be created.

Question

What is the file name of the compressed zip archive created by the attacker on the file server to stage sensitive financial audit files?

Answer

Financial_Audit_2026.zip

Evidence

- A `FILE_CREATION` event for `Financial_Audit_2026.zip` on `CYM-FS-01.cymbal.corp`, user `svc_backup`, created by `C:\Windows\System32\WindowsPowerShell\v1.0\powershell.exe`. The list view showed 22:26:11, which is about 21:26:11Z.
- The activity leading up to it, all by `svc_backup` on `CYM-FS-01`: `cmd.exe` launched by `wsmprovhost.exe` (a WinRM remote session, list time 22:13:11), then `powershell.exe` launched by `cmd.exe` (list time 22:19:41).
- The archive name points to financial audit data, matching the staging step described in the question.

How it was found

The search looked for archive files created in the Cymbal namespace, with a window from Oct 15 20:00 to Oct 16 06:00 UTC. It returned a single result:

```
principal.namespace = "Cymbal"
AND metadata.event_type = "FILE_CREATION"
AND target.file.full_path = /\.(zip|7z|rar)$/ nocase
```

Lesson

After lateral movement, attackers collect and compress data before exfiltrating it. The archive creation event shows both the staging step and the account that performed it.

Next pivot

Find where the archive was sent: search the file server and the `svc_backup` account for outbound transfers after the archive was created.